

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES
HOUSE CONCURRENT RESOLUTION NO. 28

BY STATE AFFAIRS COMMITTEE

A CONCURRENT RESOLUTION

STATING FINDINGS OF THE LEGISLATURE AND ENCOURAGING THE PEOPLE OF IDAHO TO
OBSERVE A DAY OF FASTING AND PRAYER ON MARCH 1, 2026, TO SEEK PEACEFUL
RESOLUTIONS TO THE CHALLENGES FACING THE STATE AND NATION, TO PRAY FOR
SNOW AND RAIN FOR IDAHO'S WATER SUPPLIES, AND TO PRAY FOR WISE DECISION-
MAKING BY STATE AND FEDERAL LEADERS.

Be It Resolved by the Legislature of the State of Idaho:

WHEREAS, in these perilous times, our nation and the world are beset by
escalating political violence, including grievous attacks and dire threats
that rend the fabric of societal stability and peace; and

WHEREAS, widespread protests across the United States, even in Idaho's
own cities such as Boise and Pocatello, bespeak profound discontent over
matters of governance, immigration enforcement, public lands, veteran bene-
fits, and perils to social security; and

WHEREAS, acts of violence at gatherings, economic uncertainties, fears
attending immigration actions, and rising tides of antisemitism and divi-
sion sow seeds of unrest in Idaho and throughout the land; and

WHEREAS, water is the very lifeblood of Idaho, sustained by bountiful
snows and rains to our mountains, yet the winter of 2026 hath brought scant
moisture, leaving our lands parched and our waters diminished; and

WHEREAS, throughout the annals of American history, in seasons of great
affliction and national calamity, the federal government hath solemnly
called upon its citizens to observe days of fasting, humiliation, and
prayer, as when the Continental Congress issued at least fifteen proclama-
tions for fasting, prayer, and thanksgiving between 1775 and 1784; and

WHEREAS, President George Washington, in humble acknowledgment of
Almighty God, proclaimed November 26, 1789, as a day of public thanksgiving
and prayer to render thanks unto Divine Providence for His manifold mercies;
and

WHEREAS, President John Adams, amid gathering storms of war, designated
May 9, 1798, as a day of solemn humiliation, fasting, and prayer, beseeching
the Ruler of Nations to avert impending conflict; and

WHEREAS, President James Madison, during the trials of the War of 1812,
set apart July 9, 1812, as a day of public humiliation and prayer, entreating
divine aid for the republic's deliverance; and

WHEREAS, President James Buchanan, facing the shadows of national dis-
solution, called for a day of humiliation, fasting, and prayer on December
14, 1860, imploring God's mercy upon a divided people; and

WHEREAS, President Abraham Lincoln, in the midst of the Civil War's bit-
ter strife, appointed April 30, 1863, as a day of national humiliation, fast-
ing, and prayer, urging the nation to confess its sins and seek reconcilia-
tion under Providence; and

1 WHEREAS, in more recent eras, the National Day of Prayer, ordained by
2 Congress in 1952 and observed annually on the first Thursday in May, perpetu-
3 ates this sacred tradition of seeking divine guidance in times of need; and

4 WHEREAS, the State of Idaho hath long honored such observances, as
5 when Governor Brad Little joined Idahoans in recognizing the National Day
6 of Prayer in 2021, and the Idaho Legislature hath supported daily times of
7 prayer during its sessions; and

8 WHEREAS, kindred states in recent years have issued like calls, as Ten-
9 nessee proclaimed July 2024 a month of prayer and fasting for God's mercy;
10 Utah Governor Spencer Cox declared September 1, 2024, a day for national
11 contemplation and June 29, 2025, a day of prayer and fasting for rain amid
12 drought; and Texas Governor Greg Abbott set July 6, 2025, as a day of prayer
13 for flood victims, urging citizens to seek solace and strength in faith; and

14 WHEREAS, these proclamations oft invoke humility, repentance, unity,
15 and earnest supplication for divine intervention in afflictions such as nat-
16 ural disasters, societal discord, and moral decay.

17 NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED by the members of the Second Regular Ses-
18 sion of the Sixty-eighth Idaho Legislature, the House of Representatives and
19 the Senate concurring therein, that the Legislature humbly encourages the
20 people of Idaho to observe March 1, 2026, as a day of fasting and prayer, vol-
21 untarily uniting in a spirit of profound humility and repentance.

22 BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that on this solemn day, Idahoans are earnestly
23 urged to fast and, in humble supplication, beseech Divine Providence for
24 peaceful resolutions to the afflictions besetting our state and nation, in-
25 cluding violence, protests, and societal discord, imploring guidance toward
26 unity and reconciliation among all peoples.

27 BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that on this day, Idahoans are exhorted to fast
28 and pray unto Almighty God for abundant moisture to replenish our state's
29 vital water supplies, that our mountains may be crowned with snow and our
30 rivers flow with life-giving waters.

31 BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that fervent prayers be offered unto Divine Prov-
32 idence for our state and federal leaders, that they may be endowed with wis-
33 dom to render decisions guided by justice, compassion, and unity, and for
34 God's gracious blessings and protection upon Idaho's communities and fami-
35 lies and this great nation.

36 BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the Chief Clerk of the House of Representa-
37 tives be, and is hereby authorized and directed to forward a copy of this Res-
38 olution to the Congress of the United States, to the Governor of Idaho, and to
39 all appropriate faith leaders and faith organizations throughout the state.